

A FINITE WORLD CAN SUPPORT ONLY A FINITE POPULATION

OVERPOPULATION

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

Garrett Hardin (1915–2003)

BEFORE

1798 Thomas Malthus forecasts that continued population growth will exhaust global food supplies by the mid-19th century.

1833 In *Two Lectures on the Checks to Population*, British economist William Forster Lloyd discusses overpopulation, using the example of common land, which is less productive if too many cattle graze it.

AFTER

1974 A United Nations conference in Bucharest creates the UN's first World Population Plan of Action.

2013 British social geographer Danny Dorling outlines in *Population 10 Billion* why it is unlikely the world's population will ever reach that number, contrary to UN estimates.

In 1968, two scientists in the US issued dire warnings about overpopulation. Ecologist Garrett Hardin predicted that Earth's resources would soon be used up and environmental damage would increase. In *The Tragedy of the Commons*, he cited examples of several major global crises that had been